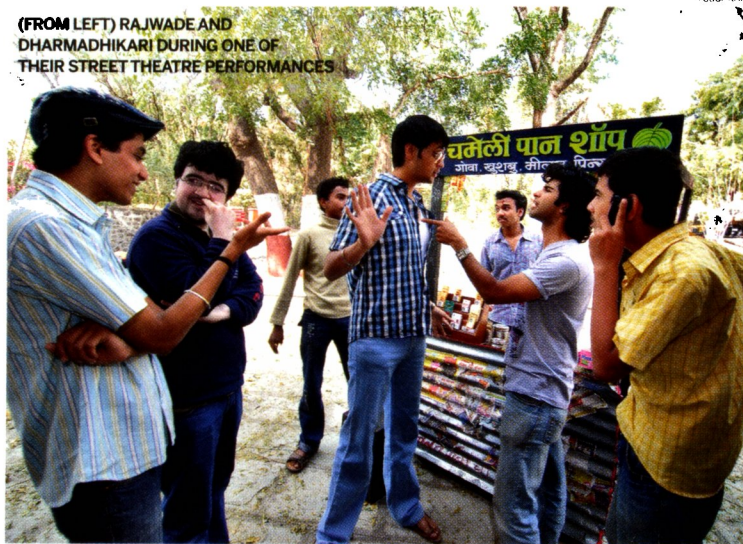


(FROM LEFT) RAJWADE AND DHARMADHIKARI DURING ONE OF THEIR STREET THEATRE PERFORMANCES



Theatre Hopefuls *Pune*

The Stage is Set

DREAM

To promote theatre as a career

Nipun Dharmadhikari, 22, starts his day with a two-hour theatre practice session that ends at 8.30 in the morning. He then heads to work at 9.30. A final year chartered accountancy student, he returns home by nine in the evening and gets busy with his assignments. Even though that seems like a lot on his plate, he would not have it any other way. His reasoning, "I know this will end some day and then I can focus entirely on my passion." That passion is theatre. It's something he realised a little over a year ago when he formed the experimental theatre group, Natak Company,

with Aalok Rajwade, 20. A final year chartered accountancy student, he began acting in inter-college competitions like Purushottam Karandak and Zee Karandak, and also performed in several theatre groups. Since then, Dharmadhikari has directed several award-winning plays including *Baap-janma*, *Sharam Gayi Toh*, 36 and *Dalan*, which was adjudged the Best Play at Thespo X, a theatre festival organised at Prithvi Theatre in Mumbai. There has been no looking back for him since then. Rajwade's fascination for theatre, on the other hand, has its roots in a school play he acted in Class VI. Now a final year BCom student in Pune's Brihan Maharashtra College of Commerce, Dharmadhikari's alma mater, he rarely attends classes. "I study a month before the exams, and that usually suffices," he says. He's already acted in *Udheboon*, a national award-winning short film. But theatre will always be a part of his life. For both, it may be low on pay, but it's high on artistic satisfaction. **by Nishat Bari**

"I want to turn theatre into a profitable profession so that playwrights can raise families without much struggle."

NIPUN DHARMADHIKARI
Co-founder, Natak Company

Radio Jockeys *Chennai*

Making Waves

They are giggly, garrulous and have gumption. The RJs at Hello FM, prime among the eight radio channels in Chennai, are the voices that rule the city air. Girish, 23, never dreamt of being an RJ. He worked nights at a call centre to support himself through college because he wanted to stand on his own feet. "Working at night was so liberating," he says. But now he finds his day job so exciting that he's given up his American dream forever and wants to launch his own media house. Part of a young team—Kaushi, 23, Lavanya,

"I wanted to own a BMW in the US. Now I'd rather be a star RJ right here at home."

GIRISH RJ, Hello FM

